

Intel-Driven Detection: From Report to Response

The loop

Intel report arrives

- > assess: FINISH (confidence, relevance to MY stack)
- > priority: which technique can I detect today?
- > build: Sigma/YARA/EDR rule for the IOA + IOC
- > deploy: staging, tune false positives
- > hunt: search historical logs for the pattern
- > respond: if a hit -> IR handoff; if none -> documentation of coverage-gap
- > update ATT&CK layer + share back

A concrete session

Say intelligence says: 'Recent phishing delivers **Emotet**; it uses Excel 4.0 macros dropping a DLL in %APPDATA% and beaconing to a specific C2 port.'

Your build:

1. SAL: Excel process spawning cmd.exe/powershell (Sigma, parent-child)
2. DNS: high DNS queries to random subdomains of known C2 domains (IOA)
3. static: YARA on excel/xlsm 4.0-macro markers ('_xl4macros' / XLAs)
4. hunt: historical EDR search 'excel -> dll in appdata'
5. plan: if detect -> contain: kill DLL, disable macro, IOC the domain.

Common blockers (honest)

Too many feeds → analyst drowning; curate, earmark, alert

Rule tuning forever → prioritize 'critical + high-information' rules

No ownership → every intel item needs an owner + expiry

Detections die silently → revalidate quarterly (attack sim!)

Tools that help

Sigmahqs / Sigma CLI: convert to Splunk/ES/Elastic

EDR hunting UIs: endpoint rawQuery; basic signatures in tooling

MISP + integration: auto-import blocklists

The only intel that matters is intel that changed a detection, stopped a beacon, or ended an incident. Every other feed entry is a bookmark.

[← Threat Feeds, Platforms & Di...](#)

Module complete ✓